Assessment design, feedback and marking

Step-by-step guide to assessment design support, review table analysis for feedback, and marking support in Harvey

Harvey can be used to support assessment design, feedback drafting, rubric mapping, and large-scale pattern analysis.

HarveyAI should not be used to make final academic judgements, assign marks without human moderation, or process identifiable student data outside approved guardrails.

Three potential use cases for Assessment support via HarveyAI:

1. Drafting grade-band criteria and sample outlines,
2. Mapping submissions to grading criteria, and
3. Using Review Tables to analyse large sets of student submissions with citation-backed cells and manual review options to inform whole-of-cohort feedback.

In all instances, student work submitted as part of an assessment should be marked by a human first. Subsequently, student work should be treated as protected data and entered into Harvey with caution.

Assessment design

Use this process when designing or revising **assessment instructions, criteria, standards, rubrics, sample outlines, or moderation materials**.

Step	Action	What to do	Output
1	**Define the assessment problem**	Decide what you need support with: task wording, criteria, standards, rubric bands, sample outlines, feedback themes, or moderation guidance.	A clear assessment-design focus.
2	**Gather the assessment materials**	Prepare the assessment description, unit learning outcomes, relevant course learning outcomes, marking criteria, grade descriptors, word limit, weighting, submission format, and any policy constraints.	Assessment context package.
3	**State the student level**	Specify the cohort and level: first-year LLB, later-year LLB, JD, LLM, postgraduate coursework, or mixed cohort.	Level-appropriate framing.

4	**Specify the intended assessment judgement**	Identify what the assessment is meant to evidence: legal knowledge, research, statutory interpretation, legal reasoning, policy analysis, writing, oral advocacy, professional judgement, or reflection.	Validity check.
5	**Ask for draft criteria only**	Prompt Harvey to draft or revise criteria for educator review. Do not ask for a final assessment design without giving it the relevant learning outcomes and task purpose.	Draft criteria or rubric.
6	**Generate grade-band standards**	Ask for standards across Fail, Pass, Credit, Distinction, and High Distinction. The recap notes that Harvey was demonstrated drafting grade-band feedback criteria and sample student outlines to support moderation and assessment design.	Draft standards table.
7	**Check alignment**	Compare the draft criteria against the assessment task, ULOs, course outcomes, AQF level, and intended student performance. Constructive alignment requires assessment and learning activity design to prepare students for the target performances and judgements.	Alignment decision.
8	**Check criterion quality**	Remove criteria that are vague, double-counting, too broad, or not assessable from the student submission.	Cleaner criteria.
9	**Ask for sample outlines carefully**	Use sample outlines for calibration or teaching support. Avoid producing a complete model answer unless that is explicitly part of the learning design.	Sample outlines for review.
10	**Revise in educator voice**	Edit for local policy, legal accuracy, discipline conventions, and student readability.	Educator-approved assessment material.
11	**Document use**	Record what Harvey was used for, what was checked, what was changed, and who approved the final version.	Short audit note.

Prompt: draft rubric / grade-band criteria

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Using the supplied assessment task, unit learning outcomes, and assessment
context, draft an analytic rubric for educator review.

Context:
- Unit:
- Student cohort:
- Level:
- Jurisdiction:
- Assessment type:
- Weighting:
- Word limit / duration:
- Intended learning outcomes:
- Existing criteria, if any:

Task:
Create a table with the following columns:
1. Criterion
2. What the criterion assesses
3. High Distinction standard
4. Distinction standard
5. Credit standard
6. Pass standard
7. Fail standard
8. Alignment note

Constraints:
Do not invent learning outcomes.
Do not add criteria unrelated to the assessment task.
Use assessable language.
Flag any criterion that may be too broad, overlapping, or difficult to apply
consistently.
End with a section titled “Educator review required”.
Prompt: sample outlines for moderation
Using only the supplied assessment task, rubric, and source materials,
create sample outlines at three performance levels: high, satisfactory, and
weak.

The outlines should show:
1. Likely structure
2. Issue identification
3. Use of authority
4. Legal reasoning approach
5. Common omissions or weaknesses
6. How the outline relates to the rubric

Do not write a full model answer.
Do not invent authorities.
Do not assign marks.
Flag assumptions and matters requiring educator verification.
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Feedback and marking-support process

Use this process when supporting **feedback drafting, rubric mapping, moderation, feed-forward advice, or cohort-level feedback**.

This is not a process for outsourcing marking decisions.

Step	Action	What to do	Output
1	**Confirm the permitted use**	Check whether student submissions may be processed in Harvey under local guidance. If unsure, do not upload.	Go / no-go decision.
2	**Remove PII**	Remove student names, student IDs, file metadata, comments, coversheets, email addresses, and other identifying information. The recap specifically identifies the need for guardrails so student submissions uploaded to Harvey Vault exclude PII.	De-identified submission set.
3	**Prepare the marking frame**	Upload or paste the assessment task, rubric, marking criteria, grade descriptors, and any feedback conventions.	Marking context.
4	**Define the support task**	Decide whether Harvey is being used to map evidence to criteria, draft feedback comments, identify strengths and weaknesses, produce cohort themes, or support moderation.	Clear feedback task.
5	**Prohibit final judgement**	State that Harvey must not assign final marks, determine grades, or make final academic judgements.	Human-led marking boundary.
6	**Map evidence to criteria**	Ask Harvey to identify evidence in the submission that appears relevant to each criterion.	Evidence-to-criteria map.
7	**Draft feedback for review**	Ask for student-facing feedback comments linked to criteria. The recap notes that Harvey was demonstrated mapping submissions to grading criteria, analysing against grade descriptors, and assisting with feedback drafting while preserving academic oversight and policy compliance.	Draft feedback comments.

8	**Check against the submission**	Compare each suggested comment with the original student work. Delete or revise comments that overstate, infer, or misclassify performance.	Verified feedback draft.
9	**Moderate academic judgement**	Use the output as one input into academic moderation, not as the moderation decision itself.	Marker-reviewed feedback.
10	**Revise tone and feed-forward**	Ensure feedback is specific, constructive, criteria-linked, and gives students an actionable next step.	Student-ready feedback.
11	**Record the process**	Note what was uploaded, what was generated, what was checked, and what the educator changed before release.	Feedback audit note.

Prompt: map anonymised submission to criteria

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Using only the supplied anonymised student submission and supplied rubric,
map evidence from the submission to the assessment criteria.

Output table:
1. Criterion
2. Evidence in the submission
3. Apparent strength
4. Apparent weakness or omission
5. Draft feedback comment for educator review
6. Human moderation note

Constraints:
Do not assign a final mark.
Do not determine a grade.
Do not infer beyond the supplied text.
Do not identify the student.
Flag any judgement that requires academic review.
Prompt: cohort-level feedback themes
Using the supplied anonymised submissions, rubric, and assessment
instructions, identify cohort-level feedback themes.

Provide:
1. Common strengths
2. Common misunderstandings
3. Common legal reasoning issues
4. Common use-of-authority issues
5. Common writing or structure issues
6. Feed-forward advice for the next task
7. Matters requiring educator verification

Do not refer to individual students.
Do not assign marks.
Use only the supplied materials.
Keep the output suitable for educator review before release.
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Review Table / large-scale submission analysis process

Use this process when working with **multiple submissions or documents** and you need structured extraction, pattern identification, moderation support, or cohort-level analysis.

Step	Action	What to do	Output
1	**Define the analysis purpose**	Decide whether the Review Table is for moderation, common error analysis, authority-use review, issue-spotting analysis, feedback theme generation, or assessment redesign.	Analysis purpose.
2	**Prepare a de-identified upload set**	Remove PII and use neutral file names or pseudonymous identifiers where permitted. Avoid student names and IDs unless there is explicit approval and a clear governance basis.	Safer file set.
3	**Create or open the Vault**	Upload the assessment instructions, rubric, and anonymised submissions into the relevant Vault.	Source corpus.
4	**Create a Review Table**	Use the Review Table function to extract structured information across multiple files. The recap notes that Review Tables support analysis of large sets of student submissions, extraction of key data points, and moderation.	Review Table shell.
5	**Design columns around assessment judgement**	Avoid generic columns such as “summary”. Use columns that reflect the assessment task and criteria.	Assessment-aligned table.
6	**Build custom extraction columns**	Use the column builder to define precise extraction queries. The recap notes examples such as issue spotting, authorities cited, application quality, common errors, and standout strengths.	Custom extraction logic.
7	**Add verification columns**	Add manual columns for verification status, marker note, moderation issue, feedback theme, or follow-up action. The recap notes that manual input columns can be added for comments or notes.	Human-review layer.

8	**Populate the table**	Run the extraction across the uploaded submissions.	Populated table.
9	**Check citation-backed cells**	Click through the citations supporting table cells. The recap notes that each cell is supported by citations, allowing verification against original documents, with options to flag and edit cells.	Verified or corrected table cells.
10	**Flag unreliable cells**	Mark cells as verified, needs checking, incorrect, unsupported, or not applicable.	Quality-controlled table.
11	**Ask over the table**	Query the structured table for patterns, comparisons, and synthesis rather than asking for a fresh free-form answer. This mirrors the Vault workflow guidance: query the structured table, identify assumptions or gaps, and then verify against source texts.	Pattern analysis.
12	**Generate moderation insights**	Ask for likely calibration issues, recurring strengths, recurring weaknesses, and areas where criteria may need clarification.	Moderation brief.
13	**Generate feedback themes**	Use verified table patterns to draft cohort-level feedback. Do not release without educator review.	Draft cohort feedback.
14	**Use insights to improve assessment design**	Identify where students misunderstood the task, where criteria lacked clarity, or where teaching support may need revision.	Assessment redesign evidence.
15	**Archive the audit note**	Record data source, de-identification steps, extraction columns, verification approach, and final use.	Defensible workflow record.

Suggested Review Table columns for assessment analysis

Column	Purpose	Example instruction
Submission pseudonym	Track files without identifying students.	“Record the pseudonymous file label only. Do not extract names or student IDs.”
Issues identified	Analyse issue spotting.	“List the legal issues identified in the submission. Use the student’s wording where possible.”
Missing issues	Identify common omissions.	“Identify legally relevant issues from the assessment task that appear absent or underdeveloped.”
Authorities cited	Review research and authority use.	“List cases, statutes, regulations, and secondary sources cited.”
Authority use quality	Evaluate how sources are used.	“Classify whether authorities are used accurately, superficially, incorrectly, or not at all. Provide evidence from the submission.”
Application quality	Review legal reasoning.	“Assess whether the submission applies law to facts with specificity. Do not assign a mark.”
Structure	Identify communication patterns.	“Describe the organisation of the response and any major structural issue.”
Common error	Support cohort feedback.	“Identify any recurring doctrinal, reasoning, authority, or writing error.”
Standout strength	Support positive feedback.	“Identify one notable strength, if present, grounded in evidence from the submission.”
Verification status	Preserve human review.	Manual column: verified / needs checking / incorrect / unsupported / not applicable.
Moderator note	Support academic moderation.	Manual column for academic judgement and calibration comments.

Prompt: Review Table column builder instruction

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For each anonymised submission, extract the following information using only
the submitted text and the supplied assessment task and rubric:

1. Legal issues identified
2. Relevant authorities cited
3. Apparent use of statutory provisions
4. Evidence of legal reasoning and application
5. Common errors or omissions
6. Standout strengths
7. Any point that requires human moderation

Do not assign marks.
Do not determine grades.
Do not identify students.
Do not infer beyond the submission.
Cite the supporting text for each extracted claim where possible.
Prompt: Ask over a populated Review Table
Using only the populated Review Table, identify the five most common
patterns across the submissions.

For each pattern, provide:
1. Pattern name
2. Evidence from the relevant table columns
3. Why it matters for the assessment criteria
4. Draft cohort-level feedback
5. Suggested teaching or feed-forward response
6. Any limitation or uncertainty requiring educator verification

Do not refer to individual students.
Do not assign marks.
Do not make claims that are not supported by the table.
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Combined: assessment design → feedback → Review Table analysis

Phase	Main action	Harvey-output	Human review point
Before assessment release	Draft or revise assessment instructions, criteria, and standards.	Draft rubric, grade bands, sample outline structure.	Check alignment, fairness, clarity, and policy fit.
Before marking	Prepare rubric mapping and feedback language.	Feedback templates, marker guidance, moderation checklist.	Confirm criteria interpretation and marking standards.
During marking / moderation	Map anonymised work to criteria.	Evidence-to-criteria tables and draft feedback comments.	Academic judgement, grading, moderation, and final feedback approval.

After marking	Analyse cohort patterns.	Common strengths, common errors, authority-use patterns, feed-forward themes.	Verify patterns and decide what to communicate to students.
For future redesign	Use evidence to improve teaching and assessment.	Recommendations for clearer instructions, better scaffolding, or revised criteria.	Educator and governance review.

Safe-use checklist

Check	**Question**
Data protection	Has all PII been removed before upload?
Task boundary	Is Harvey being used for drafting, mapping, extracting, or summarising — not final judgement?
Criteria supplied	Has the rubric or marking frame been provided?
Source grounding	Can each extracted claim be traced back to the submission or rubric?
Citation checking	Have Review Table citations been checked?
No final marks	Has final grading remained with the educator?
Moderation visible	Are judgement calls flagged for academic review?
Student-facing release	Has feedback been edited for accuracy, tone, and usefulness?
Audit note	Is there a record of what was uploaded, generated, checked, and revised?

These three processes should be treated as a single assessment-support cycle:

design the assessment carefully → use Harvey to draft and structure support materials → use feedback workflows to map evidence to criteria → use Review Tables to identify cohort patterns → verify everything → make final academic decisions yourself.

This document contains text generated by ChatGPT5.4 via Harvey AI [Grammar, spelling, syntax, library, vault]